Research Terms

Effective 1 September 2026

These terms cover a study from brief to delivery: quotation, sample and fieldwork, quality, payment, and the protection of the people who take part.

1. Scope and acceptance

“You” means the organisation or researcher using the workspace (the Client); “we” and “us” mean Guanyi Media. Opening a workspace, submitting a brief, accepting a quotation or publishing a questionnaire means you accept these terms.

You confirm that you are authorised to act for the Client and are responsible for what workspace members do. A written project agreement may add to these terms, but may not fall below the participant protections in section 7.

2. Briefs, proposals and quotations

The brief is yours to provide and should state the decision, the audience, the market, the sample expected and the timing required. The more specific it is, the more precise the proposal; we may ask for clarification, and scheduling shifts while it is outstanding.

We respond with a proposal covering scope, method, sample structure, deliverables, timing, fees and assumptions. The quotation’s validity is as stated on it; where the scope changes — audience, market, length, quotas, timing — we may re-quote.

Price lock. Once a quotation is confirmed, the price holds for the scope it describes. Extra cost arising from a change you request, or from acceleration, is confirmed separately.

3. Sample, quotas and fieldwork

Feasibility is assessed against the market, the audience conditions and the quota structure at the time of confirmation. We state the expected recruitment period and any alternatives; the final quota table is confirmed by both sides before fieldwork begins.

Quotas are filled cell by cell and stop when a cell is full; responses beyond the target are not billed. If a cell cannot be filled within the agreed period, we explain why and propose adjusted conditions, an extension, or a proportional refund for that cell.

We do not guarantee that any particular person will take part, qualify or complete, nor any specific response rate or completion date; these depend on audience size, recruitment difficulty and conditions outside our control.

4. Data quality and remedy

Returned data is checked for quality, including interview length, straight-lining, attention checks, duplicate submissions and the quality of open answers. The checks and their outcome are reported with the delivery.

Remedy. Where delivered data falls below the agreed standard for reasons attributable to fieldwork, we top up the affected sample at no charge. If the topped-up data still does not meet the agreed standard, we refund the proportion affected or, if you agree, replace it with equivalent service. This is the primary remedy for quality.

Issues caused by questionnaire design, logic settings, length or audience conditions you supplied are not fieldwork quality issues; we help investigate, and the resulting work may be chargeable.

5. Delivery and acceptance

Deliverables are those listed in the quotation, typically cleaned data files, a codebook and a quality note. You raise any issue about completeness, quota attainment or agreed definitions within the acceptance period stated in the quotation or delivery notice; after that the delivery is accepted.

Delivered data is retained as stated in the Privacy Policy and the quotation. If you need it kept longer, ask in writing before the retention period ends.

6. Payment, invoices and taxes

Payment follows the quotation: typically a deposit once scheduling is confirmed, with fieldwork starting after it clears, and the balance on acceptance.

Invoices are issued on receipt and are available under Invoices and billing. If payment is overdue we may pause this and other studies, and reserve our rights.

Prices exclude taxes payable by you under applicable law. Bank charges, intermediary deductions and exchange losses on cross-border payment are borne by the payer; where withholding applies, you provide the withholding certificate.

7. Participant protection and compliance

Participants are the subject of the research, not a data source. Together we meet the following:

- explain the purpose, expected length, data use, incentive and how to withdraw before the questionnaire begins;
- collect nothing unrelated to the stated purpose, and obtain separate consent for any sensitive category, with the safeguards described;
- never ask participants for passwords, verification codes, card or bank details, government identity documents or biometric identifiers;
- raise in advance any study involving minors, medical, psychological or financial topics, and obtain our written confirmation;
- obtain ethics approval where law or an institution requires it, and provide the approval;
- never use research as cover for marketing, fundraising, recruitment or identity verification;
- never re-identify a participant, or contact them outside the study they took part in.

If these are not met we may pause the study; the resulting cost and responsibility are yours.

8. Data, outputs and intellectual property

Materials you provide remain yours; you grant us the limited licence needed to carry out the study.

Outputs — data files, analysis and reports — belong to you once payment is complete, and may be used for your research and decisions. We retain the rights in our methodology, templates, tools and platform.

For quality improvement and sector benchmarks we may use de-identified, aggregated statistics that do not identify you or any participant, and we do not disclose your project content to third parties.

Hosting and fieldwork may involve service providers acting on our instructions under written data-protection terms. We remain responsible for what they do with your data, and tell you which categories of provider are involved when a study requires it.

9. Confidentiality

Each side keeps the other's non-public information confidential and uses it only to perform the study. Confidentiality continues after the study for three years; where disclosure is legally required, the other side is notified first where possible and the disclosure is kept as narrow as the requirement allows.

Participant information is handled under section 7 and the Privacy Policy, and this clause does not widen its use.

10. Cancellation, postponement and termination

Where you cancel a scheduled study, settlement follows the quotation: sample, recruitment and fieldwork costs already incurred are settled as incurred, and work already completed is not refundable.

Where performance is prevented by events beyond reasonable control — platform failure, a sudden change in market conditions, a regulatory requirement — the parties agree a postponement or a refund for the part not performed.

Either side may terminate for material breach that is not remedied within a reasonable period after written notice. Termination does not

affect payment obligations already incurred or the confidentiality obligations.

11. Liability

To the fullest extent permitted by law, our total liability for a study is limited to the fees received for that study, and neither side is liable for indirect, incidental, special or consequential loss.

We do not warrant the correctness of a research conclusion or any commercial outcome. Decisions you take on the basis of the research are yours.

Nothing here limits liability that law does not allow to be limited, or any right a participant has under applicable law.

12. General

Indemnity. You indemnify us against third-party claims arising from the research you commission — questionnaire content, recruitment criteria, incentives or use of the findings — to the extent the claim results from your breach of these terms, the Acceptable Use Policy or applicable law.

Force majeure. Neither side is liable for delay or failure caused by events beyond reasonable control, provided the affected side informs the other and resumes as soon as it can.

Publicity. Once a study is delivered we may cite the engagement in credentials, unless you object in writing.

Severability and order. If a provision is unenforceable it is read down to the minimum extent needed and the rest stands. Between these terms, the Terms of Service and a quotation, the quotation controls for that study, and these terms control over the Terms of Service.

13. Changes and contact

We may update these terms as the service, research practice or the law changes. Material changes are notified through the workspace or by email before they take effect.

For a study, write to heguanyi@guanyi-media.com with the project name or reference in the subject line.

Issued in English. Any translation is provided for convenience only.